

RHYTHM TOOLKIT

5 Steps to “Feeling” Rhythm



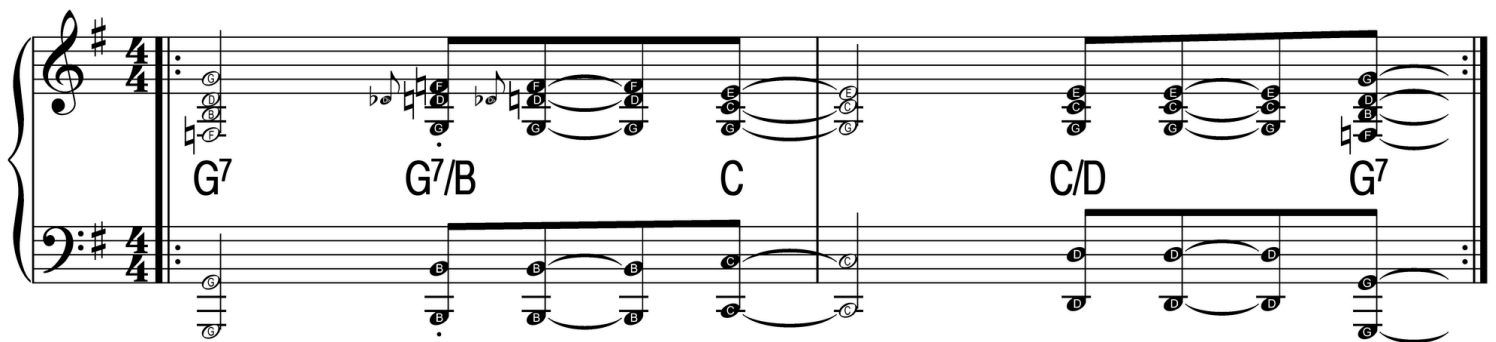
Introduction *from Adam*

These five rhythm steps are my go-to framework for moving rhythm out of your head and into your fingers. They’re easy to try, fun to practice, and make your playing feel instantly more natural.

Step #1

Drum Tracks video 0:33

Playing along with drum tracks gets you out of your head and into the music. Instead of counting, you start reacting and **listening** – that’s when rhythm begins to feel **effortless**.



Use the **Drum Track Pack** that accompanies this video to practise listening to the individual parts of the drum kit — **bass drum, snare, and hi-hat** — and notice how each one contributes to the overall groove. Start by locking into the hi-hat!

Step #2

Chords on Beat 1



video 3:04

At this stage, **simplicity** is key. Choose a basic chord progression and concentrate on hitting **beat one** accurately every time. This develops your timing and gives your playing a stronger rhythmic foundation.

Strong Beat 1!

Step #3

Head to Body



video 5:24

Great rhythm isn't just something you think — it's something you feel physically. Try relaxing your shoulders, tapping your foot, or gently moving with the groove.



"These small movements help you connect more naturally to the rhythm."

Step #4

Subdivide



video 7:40

Once you're comfortable landing on beat one, try adding a simple rhythm. Listen closely to the drum groove and pick out a pattern — maybe from the **kick or hi-hat** — then place your chords on those beats. This helps you feel subdivisions **naturally** rather than count them.

As you add subdivisions, remember to stay relaxed and sit back into the groove. Avoid rushing — let the rhythm breathe.

Step #5

Pushes



video 10:00

Once you're comfortable with subdivisions, try adding a **push**. Bring a chord in just before the beat to create **movement** and lift. It's a subtle change that adds a lot of character.